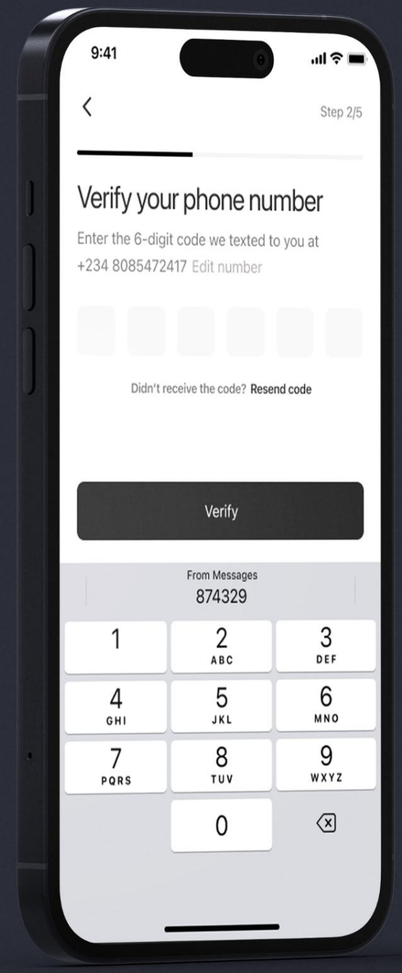
# Improving User Experience in Indian Banking Applications

This project focused on evaluating the user experience of Indian banking and fintech applications to understand how trust, familiarity, and clarity influence financial interactions.

**Type** UX Case Study

**Time** 1 month

**Team** Individual project

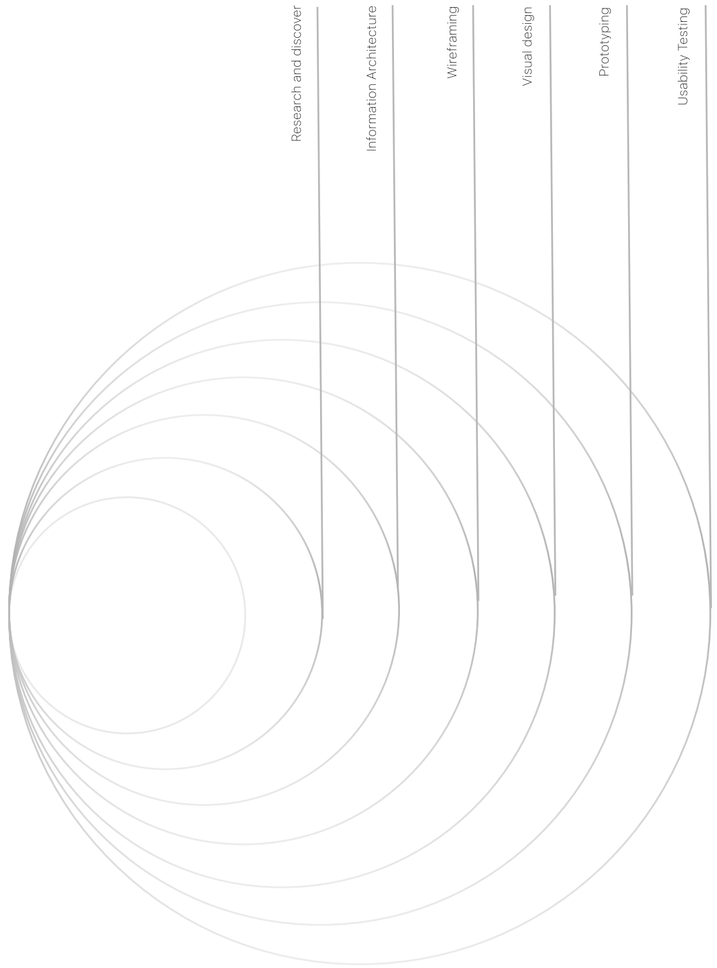


# How do differences in UX design across Indian banking apps affect user trust, clarity, and ease of use?

# Why this question matters

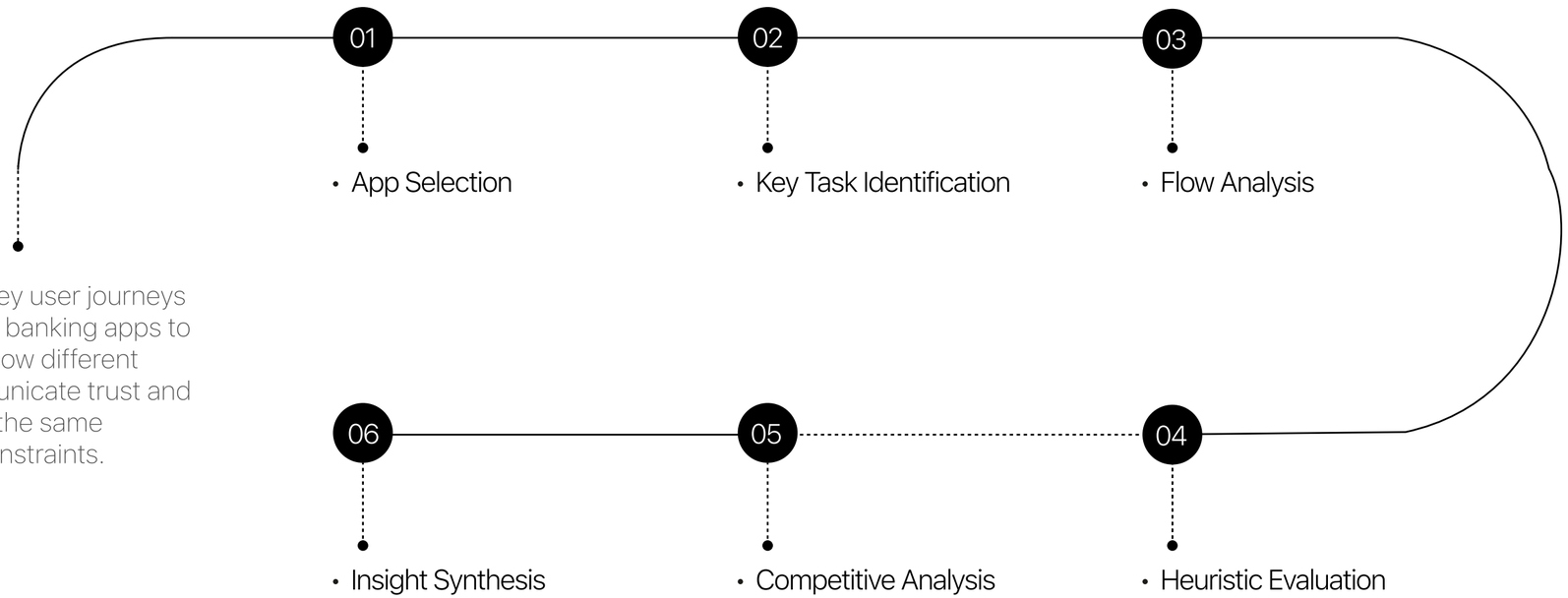
Through my work on multiple Indian banking platforms, I observed that similar tasks felt drastically different across apps, often influencing how confident and secure users felt while performing the same actions.

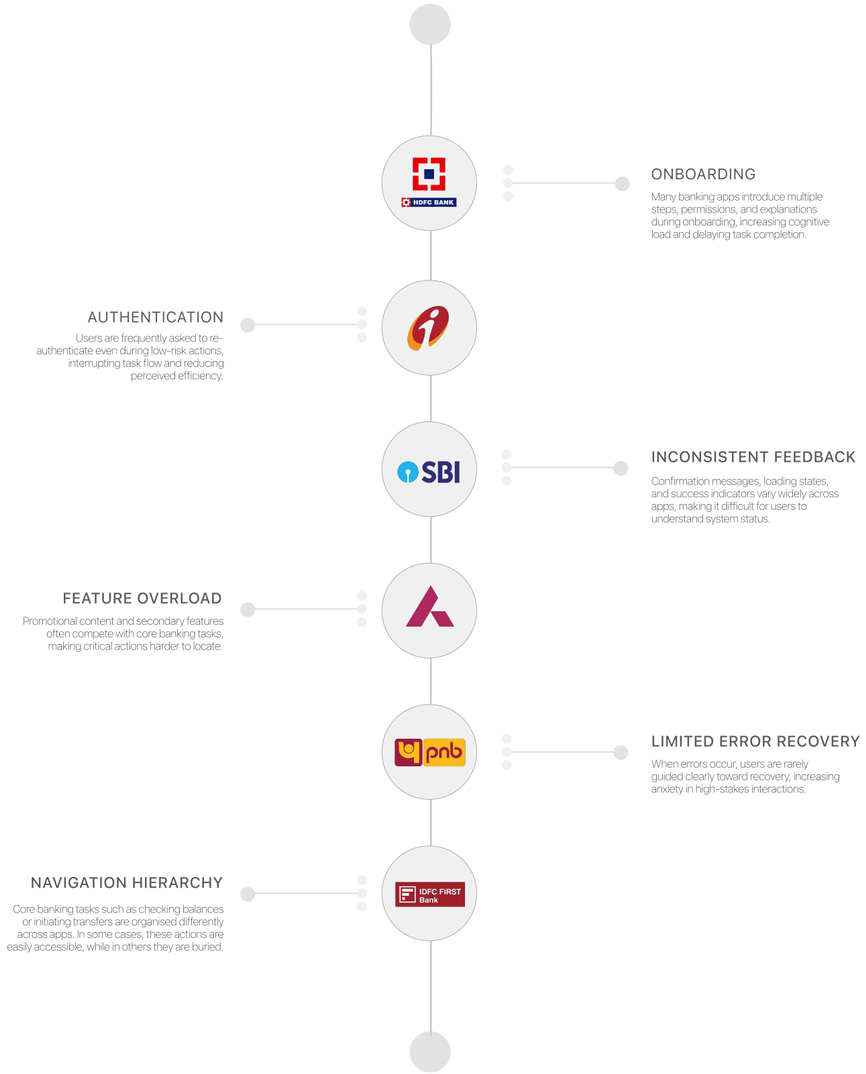
Banking applications are used in high-stakes situations involving money, personal data, and trust. Unlike consumer or retail apps, users approach banking interfaces with caution, expecting predictability, clarity, and reassurance at every step. In this context, even small usability issues can lead to anxiety, errors, or loss of confidence in the system.



# How were these banking experiences evaluated?

I compared key user journeys across Indian banking apps to understand how different banks communicate trust and clarity within the same regulatory constraints.






# What patterns emerge across Indian banking apps?

Comparing similar user journeys across India's leading banking apps reveals differences in how core interactions are structured, communicated, and prioritised.

# Assessing Usability Through the User's Lens

Through my work on multiple Indian banking platforms, I observed that similar tasks felt drastically different across apps, often influencing how confident and secure users felt while performing the same actions. Banking applications are used in high-stakes situations involving money, personal data, and trust

### User Control & Freedom

Axis and IDFC offer clearer exit points and back navigation during tasks like transfers or form entry, giving users a stronger sense of control. In comparison, PNB and SBI often limit easy recovery options, making it harder for users to undo actions or safely exit flows without restarting

### Consistency & Standards

Apps such as HDFC and ICICI follow more consistent layout patterns and terminology across screens, aligning with common digital banking conventions. Meanwhile, SBI and PNB show greater variation in labels, icon usage, and navigation patterns, increasing the learning effort required when users move between tasks.

### Visibility of System Status

Across apps like ICICI, HDFC, and Axis, system feedback during actions such as loading or transaction confirmation is generally clear and timely. In contrast, SBI and PNB often rely on delayed or minimal feedback, making it harder for users to understand whether an action is still processing or completed.

### Error Prevention

Some apps, particularly ICICI and HDFC, proactively prevent errors by validating inputs early and guiding users through complex steps. Others, such as PNB and SBI, surface errors later in the process, increasing frustration and the risk of repeated mistakes during sensitive interactions.

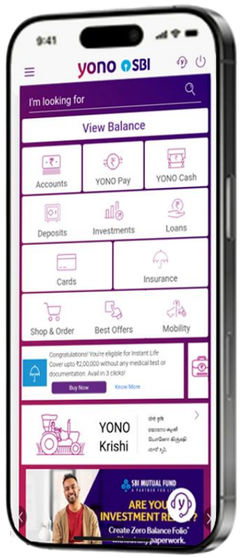
### Recognition Rather Than Recall

Axis and HDFC rely more on visible options, prompts, and contextual cues, allowing users to recognise actions rather than remember steps. In contrast, SBI and PNB sometimes require users to recall information or navigation paths, increasing cognitive load, especially for infrequent users.

### Help, Guidance & Error Recovery

When errors occur, IDFC and ICICI tend to provide clearer messages and next steps, helping users recover and proceed confidently. PNB and SBI, however, often provide generic error messages with limited guidance, leaving users unsure how to resolve the issue or what to do next.

Cluttered home screens - Too many options and promotions hide important tasks, making simple actions harder and slower.







Confusing chatbot - Chatbots feel unclear and hard to trust, leaving users unsure when or why to use them.

# Where Do Users Struggle Across Banking Apps?

I observed that while many have mastered quick biometric logins, the experience fails on the dashboard. Essential features like checking balances or transferring funds are often buried under ads and "special offers." Users shouldn't have to hunt for daily tasks; it’s simply easy to get in, but hard to use.

# How can the experience be improved?

### Clear step-by-step flow

Users should always know where they are and what comes next, especially during login, payments, and transfers.

### Consistent feedback

Actions like payments, logins, or errors should give clear confirmation, not leave users guessing.

### Fewer interruptions

Security checks should feel necessary, not repetitive, and appear only at meaningful moments.

### Simpler language

Banking terms should be explained in plain, everyday language, not technical or legal wording.

### Better error recovery

If something fails, users should know what went wrong and how to fix it, without panic.

### Core tasks first

Important actions like checking balance or sending money should be easy to find, not hidden behind promotions.

# Key UX Learnings from RBI

Trust > innovation in financial systems

Familiarity reduces cognitive load for mass users

Consistency builds institutional credibility

# What did this project teach me about UX in regulated environments?

This project helped me understand that in public financial systems, usability is inseparable from trust. Designing for millions of users in India showed me that clarity, familiarity, and restraint often matter more than visual innovation. It reshaped how I think about responsibility in human-centred design